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HP Elitebook Folio

Business, class



The HP Elitebook Folio is meant for business consumers and represents a new line of ultrabooks that is expected to become mainstream soon. It's like a Windows-powered Macbook, with two USB ports instead of one. That obviously offers easier connectivity than the Macbook, but USB Type-C is still a tough standard to deal with. Adapters are quite expensive, and you will need to have wireless devices to use this laptop effectively, for now.

The laptop has a silver aluminium body, and it's slimmer than some smartphones, and the touch-screen variant we reviewed, weighs only about 1kg. It's a really good looking laptop, but not flashy, like the HP Spectre. The Folio typically suits business usage. The Type-C ports are on the right, while a 3.5mm audio jack resides on the left. That's all you get by way of ports.

Its wobbling hinge is the only point of contention. The display can tilt back 180 degrees, but the loose wobbles often. For example, when you're in a car, the display keeps tilting back as you try to use the laptop on your lap.

Speaking of the display, HP decided to bring only the 1080p variant to India. It measures only 420 lux at its brightest (at the centre), which is dimmer than what you may want in this price range. It's not uniformly bright either, with the numbers being lower near the corners. Adding to that is its reflectiveness, which makes it difficult to use outdoors. To be clear, the viewing angles are great, but the reflectiveness gets in the way of that.

The display is sharp, though, and the colours are adequate, if not great. The Elitebook Folio doesn't create the deepest blacks, but few would complain about the colours. Overall, it's not the best display in this price range, but one that works for most.

As mentioned above, the Elitebook Folio has a great keyboard, which is HP's feat of engineering

here, given the thinness. The backlit chiclet keyboard has great key travel, with good feedback. It produces a pleasant clack noise, which regular typists will enjoy, and we never bottomed out the keys while typing, which is good as well. It's one of the best keyboards that we've seen on a laptop.

The same can not be said about the touchpad, however. While it is big enough, and Windows gestures work well, the touchpad refuses to scroll at times. This can be quite annoying, and we couldn't find a fix for it. The drivers were updated and there's nothing in the settings that would come in the way of seamless two finger scrolling.

The Elitebook Folio also has bottom firing speakers, which have been tweaked by Bang & Olufsen. They're loud enough to be heard in silent rooms, but not enough for more noisy situations. The audio quality is quite clear, though, for a laptop this thin. You can also use the in-built B&O equaliser, which is turned on by default, to tweak the audio to your liking.

The Core M7 Pro processor, which runs the Folio is quite fast for all business tasks. It showed no lags while using Google Docs, Sheets, MS Word, Excel and so on. While it isn't as powerful as its iX series counterparts, it handled multitasking with ease. There were no significant stutters with a dozen tabs open on Chrome, and streaming videos side by side. There's really little to complain, unless you're looking to run really heavy software on this device. The temperature on the keyboard never exceeded 27 degrees, while the bottom approached 33 degrees at best.

While low temperatures is one of the USPs of Intel's M-series processors, battery life still seems to need work. The Elitebook Folio got us 7 hours at best, with four hours of typing and two hours of video streaming included. It's satisfactory, but not the best for a business class ultrabook. There are competitors in this price range that can hit the 10-hour mark. If the 1080p model does 7 hours, then the 4K model should be far from ideal.

All in all, while the Elitebook Folio is amongst the best ultrabooks in the market today, it's not the best. HP's Client Security and Sure Start solutions provide good security options, and the performance is unquestionable, but the display and battery life can be a letdown. Devices like the Asus UX305CA can offer better value, at a slightly lower price.

Prasid Banerjee



Design.....	94
Features.....	67
Performance.....	73
Value.....	67

Specifications

Display: 12.5 inch FHD Touch display; **Processor:** Intel 6th Gen m7-6Y75/ m5-6Y54 CPU; **RAM:** 8GB; **Storage:** 256GB; **Ports:** 2xUSB Type-C (USB 3.0 adapter included); **Operating System:** Windows 10 Professional

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